

SecondKind Bold — Phase 1 Strategic Synthesis

Generated 2026-05-23. Reference doc for the bold-variant paid acquisition launch. Pulls from `brand.yaml`, `positioning.md`, all 6 personas, the Tier-3 social scrape (282 comments across IG/TT/YT), VOC corpus (`voc/extracted_pains.yaml`), gap map (`research/competitive-gaps.yaml`), and creative matrix (`strategy/creative_matrix.yaml`, 52 rows across 4 tabs).

Executive summary

The probiotic category has spent two decades selling dead bacteria. Five of the six SecondKind ICPs already suspect this in their bodies — they just don't have language for it. The bold variant's only job is to give them that language, prove the indictment with receipts in the next line, and convert them on mechanism. The single biggest lever is **vindication before conversion** — naming what they already suspected and exonerating them for it ("you weren't wrong, the product was") before introducing postbiotics as the missing piece. That arc fits the dominant heuristic pair (`framing_effect` + `authority_bias`) across all 6 personas. The matrix has 52 rows; the top 10 are ranked at the bottom of this doc, and the one to ship first is `pain-010`.

1. The bold thesis

Captured in three lines from `positioning.md`:

- We don't sell bacteria. We sell what your gut was waiting for them to produce.*
- The probiotic-industrial complex is the named enemy at the **category level**. The customer is the protagonist; the voice always sides with her against the industry. **Wry, not sneering**. Every claim is backed by a receipt in the next line.*
- The four-beat arc on every piece: **name the suspicion she already had** → **diagnose the mechanism** → **vindicate her** → **convert with the offer**.*

Receipts in the arsenal (load-bearing facts)

Claim	Source
~70% of live probiotic bacteria die in gastric transit	Widely documented in nutritional science literature
EpiCor® — 17% reduction in cold/flu symptom days	12-week RCT
Bereum® — improved GI symptoms, perceived stress, quality of life	84-day human study
Totipro® — bowel regularity outcomes	30-day clinical trial

The colonization problem (live bacteria don't reliably establish)	Standing nutritional-science consensus
The plateau effect (initial relief regresses within months)	Standing nutritional-science consensus + repeated VOC pattern

Hard rules (from `brand.yaml`)

- **Never** name competitors by brand. Category-level indictment only.
- **Never** mock the customer's past purchases. The cut lands on the industry or the mechanism, never on her.
- **Never** bash doctors. Frame as "literature ahead of practice."
- **Never** lead with operational claims (60-day guarantee, refund). Those close. Lead with mechanism.
- Body / aesthetic shame is permitted **only when the punch lands on the mechanism, not on her** — and is off-limits for Natalie (postpartum) entirely.

2. The six ICPs

Five of six sit at `problem_aware`. Only one (Practitioner Paul) is `solution_aware`. This shapes the entire frame: we are not introducing a category, we are reframing a category they've already burned out on.

#	Persona	Awareness	Emotional quadrant	Top heuristics	Reachable moment
1	Done-Everything Danielle (primary)	<code>problem_aware</code>	LV/HI	<code>authority_bias</code> , <code>framing_effect</code>	Finishes another bottle, feels no different. Quiet ground-shift instant.
2	Immune-Anxious Isaac (secondary)	<code>problem_aware</code>	LV/LI	<code>authority_bias</code> , <code>framing_effect</code>	Monday back at his desk after a missed deadline / third illness this year.
3	New-Mom Natalie (tertiary)	<code>problem_aware</code>	HV/LI	<code>framing_effect</code> , <code>social_proof</code>	Late-night nursing scroll. The 90-second stolen window.
4	Practitioner Paul (quaternary)	<code>solution_aware</code>	LV/HI	<code>authority_bias</code> , <code>social_proof</code>	Third patient that week reports their probiotic did nothing.
5	Perimenopause Paula	<code>problem_aware</code>	LV/LI → LV/HI spikes	<code>framing_effect</code> , <code>authority_bias</code>	Night before a vacation or professional photo.
6	Burnout Biohacker Brandon	<code>problem_aware</code>	LV/LI	<code>authority_bias</code> , <code>framing_effect</code>	Mid-stack-audit of 12+ months of probiotic spend.

Persona cards (compressed)

Done-Everything Danielle — Suburban 30-44yo, \$90-160K HHI, label-reader, listens to Huberman. Identity is "the informed one" — does everything right and still bloats by dinner. *Distinctive language:* "I know, I know, another supplement" / asks mechanism questions first. The bold variant's center-of-mass persona — most of the matrix rows test her first.

Immune-Anxious Isaac — Urban male knowledge worker 32-48, \$100-180K HHI. Doesn't call himself

"wellness" but tracks sleep, runs zone 2, optimizes a small stack. Pragmatic register, demands the mechanism + a study. *Distinctive language*: "Things that actually do something, not just boxes I'm checking." Reachable via the EpiCor stat in podcast-clip aesthetic — never lifestyle imagery.

New-Mom Natalie — 28-38yo, 6-24 months postpartum. Quietly grieving the predictable body. *Distinctive language*: "I just want to feel like me again." **Frame is return, never reinvention.** Mom-to-mom voice, ingredient transparency screened in-frame, phone-shot intimate aesthetic. Body shame off-limits.

Practitioner Paul — Licensed practitioner (naturopath, integrative MD, RD, health coach) carrying professional risk on probiotic recommendations that aren't working. The only solution-aware persona. *Distinctive language*: "short-chain fatty acids," "RCT," "Every brand now says postbiotic — most of them don't actually mean it." Reachable via practitioner-to-practitioner long-form delivered by a third-party credentialed voice.

Perimenopause Paula — 42-54yo, \$110-200K HHI. Doctor told her labs are "fine." Hormonal-explanation gap — her structural objection is "if it's hormonal, gut products can't fix it." Conversion requires the mechanism reframe (perimenopause depletes postbiotic output independent of probiotic input). *Distinctive language*: "supposedly," "claims to," "I'm not interested in another supplement with a pretty label and no evidence."

Burnout Biohacker Brandon — 38-55, \$140-250K+ HHI, meticulous health stack (CGM, HRV, 8-12 morning capsules). The "completion" frame is the only one that closes him: he was *right* to pursue gut health, he was just missing the active compound. *Replacement framing kills the sale; completion framing earns it.* Distrusts "game-changer / transformative / revolutionary" — responds to "clinically studied / patented complex / bioavailable."

Cross-persona observations

1. **authority_bias and framing_effect are dominant heuristics on all 6 personas.** Every ad in Phase 1 must satisfy both — the receipt has to be specific *and* the frame has to do the conversion work.
2. **scarcity and temporal_discounting are weak on all 6.** Countdown timers, "feel better today," "limited time" — all categorically off-limits across the entire creative system. The buyer cohort has already been burned by urgency in this category; reusing the gimmick erodes trust.
3. **The emotional quadrant split is the cleanest segmentation lever.** Two of six (Danielle, Paul) sit in LV/HI — active frustration, professional exposure. Four of six (Isaac, Natalie, Paula, Brandon) sit in LV/LI or HV/LI — normalized compromise. **Two creative modes needed:** activate the acute cost for LV/HI; name the quiet compromise before offering exit for LV/LI.
4. **One shared mechanism wedge converts five of six.** Probiotics-as-delivery-vehicle vs. postbiotics-as-active-compound. The conceptual hinge is structural, not preferential — Natalie is the only persona where mechanism is secondary to safety/transparency framing.

2. The psychology framework — Sarah Levinger triple stack

Captured at `prompts/skills/psychology-profiling.md`. Three frameworks layered into a single diagnostic. The personas above were profiled against all three; this is the reference for *why* certain ads will and won't work on this cohort.

Layer 1 — The 9 Heuristics (purchase decision shortcuts)

A **heuristic** is a mental shortcut the brain uses to decide quickly without analyzing every detail. There are

nine well-documented heuristics that drive ad performance. Every ad activates one or more — sometimes deliberately, sometimes accidentally. The matrix tags every row with the single heuristic it leans on hardest. Same row can be re-tested under a different heuristic, but the lead heuristic determines the headline and the lead visual.

At-a-glance table first, then plain-English definitions of each heuristic below.

Heuristic	One-line gist	Dominant for	Weak for
scarcity	Limited time / quantity drives action	—	All 6 (avoid universally)
social_proof	"Others like me already do this"	Natalie, Paul, Brandon (peer-mediated)	Brandon distrusts mass / Paul demands credentialed
authority_bias	Trust expert / credential / data	All 6 (universal)	None
effect_heuristic	Gut feel / aesthetics / "feels right"	Danielle, Natalie, Paula (secondary)	Brandon, Paul, Isaac (analytical)
processing_fluency	Easy-to-understand = trustworthy	Natalie	Brandon, Paul (want depth)
temporal_discounting	Immediate over long-term	—	All 6 (avoid universally)
salience_bias	Attention grabbed by	Universal (execution-	—
goal_gradient	Accelerate as finish line nears	—	None dominant; cohort isn't on a program
framing_effect	How info is presented changes decision	All 6 (universal)	None

Plain-English definitions

1. **scarcity** — Fear of missing out. Countdown timers, "only 12 left." **Skip** — our cohort reads manufactured urgency as a tell.
2. **social_proof** — Trust what others like you are doing. Testimonials, UGC, creator endorsements. Use the *peer-mediated* version only (friend, credentialed practitioner) — never generic "everyone's using it."
3. **authority_bias** — Trust what credentialed experts say. Doctors, named studies, RCTs. **Dominant for all 6 personas.** Every claim needs a receipt in the next line.
4. **effect_heuristic** — "If it feels good, it must be good." Aesthetics and mood do the persuading. Works for Danielle / Natalie / Paula; weak for the analytical half. Always pair with framing or authority.
5. **processing_fluency** — Easy-to-understand reads as trustworthy. Clean layouts, short headlines, one claim per ad. The bold variant's voice rule ("short declarative + receipt") satisfies this naturally.
6. **temporal_discounting** — Immediate over long-term. Countdown timers, "only 12 left." **Skip** — our cohort is burned by quick-results hype already.
7. **salience_bias** — Whatever stands out in the scroll wins the click. Bold typography on black, unexpected visuals, stark whitespace. Always-on — our editorial-minimalist aesthetic *is* a salience play.
8. **goal_gradient** — Motivation rises as you near the finish line. Progress bars, loyalty ladders. **Skip** — the cohort is stack-fatigued, not on a program.
9. **framing_effect** — How you say it changes the decision, even when the facts don't change. "\$30/month" vs "\$1/day." **Load-bearing for the bold variant** — every ad reframes what the customer already

believed.

Implication: The dominant heuristic pair across the cohort is **authority_bias + framing_effect** — every Phase 1 ad must do both. Present a specific receipt (authority) AND reframe what the customer already believed (framing). The bold variant's four-beat arc — *name the suspicion* → *diagnose the mechanism* → *vindicate* → *convert* — is structurally framing+authority all the way down. Ads that lean on aesthetics-only (effect, heuristic) work for Danielle/Natalie/Paula but underperform on the analytical half of the cohort

Layer 2 — Valence × Intensity quadrants (emotional positioning)

Two axes determine the emotional shape of an ad:

- **Valence** — does the ad pull from *gain* (positive) or *loss / fear / frustration* (negative)? Not "happy vs sad" — which direction the motivation pulls.
- **Intensity** — how *hot* is the emotion? *High* = acute, in-the-moment ("I have to fix this now"). *Low* = quiet, accumulated, normalized ("this used to mean more than this").

Crossed together = 4 quadrants. Abbreviated **HV/Hi**, **HV/Li**, **LV/Hi**, **LV/Li** (H/L = High/Low, V = Valence, I = Intensity).

Quadrant	Feeling	What the ad sounds like	Personas (primary)	Lead frame
HV / Hi — High-positive, high-heat	Breakthrough, transformation	"This will make me unstoppable"	(none primary)	"Stop swallowing corpses" — only at solution-aware retargeting
HV / Li — High-positive, low-heat	Relief, permission, recognition	"I can stop fighting this"	Natalie	"You can stop fighting this"
LV / Hi — Low-negative, high-heat	Fear of mistake, "stop the bleeding"	"I have to fix this now"	Danielle, Paul	"You've been paying for the wrong category"
LV / Li — Low-negative, low-heat	Dull dissatisfaction, accepted compromise	"This used to mean more than this"	Isaac, Paula, Brandon	"You stopped expecting more. Maybe restart that."

Implication: Most of the cohort sits in LV territory (5 of 6) — meaning the motivating emotion is loss-flavored, not gain-flavored. Two of them sit at high heat (Danielle is acutely frustrated; Paul is acutely professionally exposed); three sit at low heat (Isaac, Paula, Brandon have all *normalized* the disappointment over months or years). The bold variant's natural register is LV/Hi — indict the category, expose the mechanism cost. For the LV/Li majority, the variant must downshift intensity — name the quiet compromise first, indict more softly, let the data do the prosecuting. **Never** lead with HV/Hi breakthrough hype ("transform your life," "the supplement that changes everything") — these personas were burned by exactly that hype already and the pattern-match will tank the ad.

Layer 3 — The 14 Paired-Mechanism Templates (Tether Lab Prompt Library)

A **paired mechanism** is a two-part ad recipe: one part hooks attention, the other closes the sale. There are 14 templates in the Levinger library. For this cohort, **four show up across 3+ personas** — those are our core ad shapes.

1. **first_principles_plus_loss_aversion** — Explain how the thing actually works, then name what they lose by sticking with the old option. *Ex: "Probiotics are supposed to reach the gut and produce bioactive compounds. ~70% die before they get there. You've been paying for the delivery vehicle, not*

- the payload.*" For: Danielle, Paul, Paula, Brandon. **Bold variant's primary template** — most top-10 matrix rows use it.
2. **reframing_perception_plus_emotional_trigger** — Flip how the customer sees the problem, then connect it to a felt moment. *Ex: "That's not you. That's the die-off." over a 7pm bloat shot.* For: Isaac, Natalie. The "you can stop fighting this" pairing.
3. **authority_borrowing_plus_data_insight** — Credentialed third-party voice + specific named statistic. *Ex: Dr. Shin (microbiologist) quote, then "Bereum® — 84-day human study, GI symptoms improved."* For: Isaac, Paul, Brandon. Analytical buyers trust a named outsider over the brand voice.
4. **counterintuitive_insight_plus_specificity** — Fact that contradicts the customer's assumption + immediate named specific. *Ex: "Perimenopause depletes postbiotic output independent of estrogen. EpiCor® — 12-week RCT — 17% reduction in symptom days."* For: Paula, Brandon. The "literature is ahead of practice" pairing.

Pairings to avoid for this cohort:

- **gamification_plus_time_sensitive_offer** — progress bars + countdown timers (urgency is allergic).
- **shock_factor_plus_transformation_shortcut** — "weird trick" + "transform overnight" (hype is allergic).
- **curiosity_plus_reverse_psychology** — open-loop teasers / "don't buy this" framing (cleverness reads gimmicky).

4. The two staging axes

There are two layered models to understand where any single ad lands.

Axis A — Schwartz Awareness (per audience / per avatar)

Stage	Lead with	Where personas sit
unaware	Pattern interrupt, shock stat	—
problem_aware	Agitate the felt pain in customer language	5 of 6 personas
solution_aware	Differentiate mechanism, lead with proof	Paul
product_aware	Permission to act on emotional decision (not urgency)	—
most_aware	Lead with offer	—

Axis B — Mental Stage (per ad / per moment)

Added in commit 926e062 — the "where their head is when the ad lands" axis.

Stage	What's happening	Best brief shape
trigger	A specific moment (bloated dinner, missed deadline, third illness) just shoved them into active seeking	Lean into the trigger moment verbatim
exploration	Researching, comparing, reading labels	First-principles mechanism explainers

evaluation	Already convinced of category, picking a brand	Receipts: named ingredients, named trials, named outcomes
purchase	Card out, "convince me to click"	Permission + decision confidence (not urgency)

Implication: *Even within a single problem aware persona, briefs should span all four mental stages.* The customer cycles. The same Done-Everything Danielle is in "trigger" mode at 7pm post-bloat and in "evaluation" mode at 10am scrolling LinkedIn. **A Phase 1 brief batch should cover all four mental stages per priority persona**, not just the persona's awareness level.

5. The gap map — what burned-probiotic-users actually said

From `research/competitive-gaps.yaml`. The 7 exploitable gaps, **ranked by conversion leverage for the bold variant** (i.e., which converts the most burned-probiotic users into postbiotic buyers — the variant's whole thesis):

Rank	Gap	Competitors failing	Customer evidence	Ad angle
1	~70% transit-mortality	Seed, Arrae, Ritual	"Nothing like how it's advertised. Does nothing at	"You took the 53 billion. You felt nothing. Here's the
2	"I've tried probiotics, nothing worked" mindset	Seed, Arrae, Ritual	"\$50/month I was hoping for something I could point at that had improved. I have cancelled my order."	Validate before selling.
3	Plateau effect	Seed, Ritual	Same Seed cancellation quote	"Month one worked. Month three didn't. That's not
4	GI side effects driving abandonment	Seed, Ritual	"These messed me up so bad."	"That's not detox. That's a trillion bacteria dying in your gut."
5	SIBO/IBS sufferers underserved	Seed, Arrae	"Mixed results for sibo/ibs."	"Sending live bacteria into a dysregulated gut is like sending rescue into a burning building."
6	Arrae's uneven line	Arrae	"Natural faux-zempic. Like calling a Honda Civic a faux-Ferrari."	Name your trials. Let theirs speak for themselves.
7	Futara's lack of comprehensiveness	Futara	More comprehensive options on the market.	Position against supplement stacking fatigue.

Four shared dealbreakers (category-wide vulnerabilities)

- 1. **Long-term efficacy plateau** (Seed, Ritual) → Postbiotics are pre-synthesized + stable. Bereum® 84-day documents sustained outcomes.
- 2. **GI side effects** (Seed, Ritual, Arrae) → "No live organisms. No die-off. No drama."

3. **Overhyped marketing claims** (Arrae, Seed) → Every bold-variant claim maps to named trial. Anti-cheese discipline.
4. **Price-to-efficacy mismatch** (Seed, Arrae) → Don't compete on price. *"You already paid \$50/month for something that didn't work. The price wasn't the problem."*

Strategic implication: The cross-competitor synthesis is unanimous — every major category complaint traces back to the **digestive delivery mechanism**. The bold variant doesn't need to choose between attacking Seed vs. Arrae vs. Ritual. **It indicts the structural mechanism they all share.** That's why we never name competitors — the architecture is the antagonist.

6. VOC corpus — what real customers said (with caveat)

From `voc/extracted_pains.yaml`. Mined from competitor reviews + 282 social comments.

Top 5 pains by intensity

1. **Persistent visible bloating** — *"BABY BLOATTTTT" / "nobody needs to see szn 1 of bloated in shambles" / "Heavy on the not being bloated"*
2. **Supplement industry full of unproven claims** — *"In a wellness landscape full of noise, transparency and rigorous science are what truly build trust"*
3. **Years of wasted effort on products that don't work** — *"Took me 8 years of trial-and-error to learn the same lesson"*
4. **Women's health systematically under-researched** — *"women deserve their own data"*
5. **Bloating/constipation/nausea from common protein sources** — *"I hate whey, my family loves it but I always feel bloated"*

Top 3 trigger moments

1. **Fitting breaking point after 6+ years of trial and error**
2. Summer / seasonal social urgency (*"all summer long nobody needs to see..."*)
3. Actively researching a purchase + encountering peer review

Top 3 conversion-blocking objections

1. Skepticism that supplements work at all
2. Distrust of brand claims without published evidence
3. Price anxiety on premium subscriptions

Top 5 money quotes (ad-copy ready)

1. *"Took me 8 years of trial-and-error to learn the same lesson."*
2. *"women deserve their own data"*
3. *"Publication is what turns claims into accountable science."*
4. *"Nobody needs to see season one of bloated in shambles."*
5. *"Do not let these companies get away with anyyyyyy false advertisement."*

⚠ **Critical bias caveat on VOC data**

The VOC analyst flagged this corpus with explicit confidence-lowering notes:

- 222 of 299 comments discarded as score-1 noise (emoji reactions, one-word affirmations)
- Only 6 of 247 comments in the largest set scored 4-5
- Zero score-5 in TikTok set
- Sample skews to engaged brand followers — **detractors and churned customers underrepresented**
- *Do NOT draw persona or messaging conclusions from this data alone. Treat every confidence rating as one tier lower than labeled."*

Implication: The **gap map** (competitive-gaps.yaml) is the load-bearing Phase 1 intelligence — it contains the burned-probiotic-user evidence (cancellations, plateau quotes, side-effect quitters) that drives the bold thesis. **The VOC corpus is directional supporting color, not the foundation.** The strongest bold-variant ad angles come from competitor cancellation quotes, not the IG comment scrape.

7. The creative matrix — what we have to ship

Tab	Rows	Function
pain_vs_competitor	15	Competitor weakness → our advantage. The bold variant's strongest ground.
what_they_love	12	Emotional triggers competitors solve well — what we have to match, not attack.
wishes_gaps	10	White-space asks customers wish existed.
hook_angles	15	Ready-to-shoot hook executions. Some video-only, some static.

Every row carries: complaint / what_people_say / our_advantage / format_fit / static_treatment / psychology_trigger (one Levinger heuristic) / trending_match + trending_next (current and next-best ad-format match from trending_formats.yaml).

51 of 52 rows have a trending_match. 51 of 52 have a trending_next.

8. The top 10 rows to ship first

Ranked by leverage for the bold variant specifically. Full row data is in creative_matrix.yaml; this is the prioritization layer.

Ship-first pick — pain-010

The Universal Vindication — "You weren't wrong. The product was."

The bold variant's thesis statement compressed into a single static. Runs the entire arc (suspicion → mechanism → vindication → conversion) in 8 words. Typography-only static, no production budget needed beyond layout. **Tests the bold voice's load-bearing claim at the lowest possible cost** — that customers will respond to category-indictment + exoneration faster than to product benefits. Win on pain-010 and most of the rest of the matrix is downstream.

The top 10 ranked

Rank	Row ID	Tab	Trigger	Core idea (≤15 words)
1	pain-010	pain_vs_comp	framing_effect	"You weren't wrong. The product was." (typography static)
2	pain-002	pain_vs_comp	salience_bias	70% number as indictment — black bg, single stat
3	pain-012	pain_vs_comp	salience_bias	The 7pm body problem that isn't a body problem
4	hook-002	hook	framing_effect	"You took three probiotics. That's not a you problem." (video-only)
5	pain-006	pain_vs_comp	authority_bias	Receipts card — every ingredient, every trial, no proprietary blends
6	hook-001	hook	salience_bias	Capsule dissolving in acid + "~70% dead before you swallow"
7	pain-003	pain_vs_comp	effect_heuristic	The "detox response" lie — bacteria die-off marketed as feature
8	wish-002	wishes_gaps	salience_bias	"You weren't underdosing. You were buying from the wrong category."
9	love-010	what_they_love	framing_effect	"You tried probiotics. They didn't work. That's not your fault."
10	pain-008	pain_vs_comp	authority_bias	"Natural faux-zempic." (italics) → "We'll stick to the RCT."

Why this ranking

- **6 of 10 from pain_vs_competitor** — the bold variant's strongest ground (the tab where category-indictment lives natively).
- **Diversity across the 4 tabs is maintained** (at least 1 from each), but skewed correctly.
- **Every row in the top 10 fits the four-beat arc** explicitly — no row that doesn't earn the conversion via vindication-first.
- **5 of 10 are static / typography-led** (low production cost) — protects test budget for media.
- **3 of 10 are hook executions** (one video, two visual statics) — for the rows whose strongest expression is motion or visual literalization.
- **Customer-evidence quotes are highest-fidelity** on the top rows — pain-012 ("season one of bloated in shambles") and pain-008 ("Honda Civic / faux-Ferrari") are the two cleanest native voices in the matrix.

9. The biggest levers (synthesis)

If we strip everything above down to the levers most likely to produce conversions in Phase 1, four show up.

Lever 1 — Vindication before conversion

The single biggest lever. Every persona except Natalie sits at the intersection of frustration + identity-threat about being "the kind of person who falls for marketing." The bold variant exonerates them before selling — "you weren't wrong, the product was" — which converts both the analytical personas (it satisfies their framing_effect) and the affective personas (it satisfies their effect_heuristic via felt validation). This

lever lives in pain-010, hook-002, love-010, and the LVTN version of any retargeting ad.

Lever 2 — Mechanism reframe with a receipt in the next line

The category's failure mode is hype-without-receipts. The bold variant's voice rule is "every claim is backed by a receipt in the next line." This is **the strongest differentiator from the competitive set** because it's structural, not stylistic. Seed, Arree, and Ritual can't adopt this without abandoning their existing claims.

Lives in pain-002, pain-006, pain-008, and hook-001.

Lever 3 — Body indictment that lands on the mechanism, not the body

Bloating is the cohort's #1 pain. The bold variant has unique permission to attack it because the mechanism reframe redirects causality from her body to the product ("that's not you, that's the die-off"). The measured variant can't do this — it would read as body-shaming. The bold variant can — because the cut lands on the mechanism. **Off-limits for Natalie.** Lives in pain-012.

Lever 4 — Practitioner-channel expansion (Paul)

Paul is the only solution-aware persona, which means he's the only one ready for receipts-first ads instead of vindication first. He's also the highest-trust bridge persona — a recommendation from him reaches 50-500 patients. Phase 1 should include at least one practitioner-to-practitioner long form (LinkedIn carousel, IG mechanism reel, or trade-podcast guest spot) targeting him. ROI math: even one Paul conversion = 50-500 downstream funnel entries. Not in the top 10 (because he's a different brief shape), but **strategically the cheapest scale lever.**

10. What to be careful about

Voice discipline (Sarah Lvinger framework constraints)

- **Never** use scarcity or temporal_discounting mechanics. The cohort is allergic. Countdown timers, "feel better today," limited-time framing — all read as the manufactured-urgency move that drove them away from probiotics.
- **Never** lead with shock_factor_plus_transformation_shortcut. "Miracle," "revolutionary," "life-changing" — all on the prohibited-terms list for a reason.
- **Never** use effect_heuristic alone. Aesthetics-only ads work for Danielle/Natalie/Paula but fail for the analytical half of the cohort. Pair effect with framing or authority.

VOC bias awareness

The IG comment scrape skews to brand followers. Detractors and churned customers are underrepresented. **Lean on the competitive gaps cancellation quotes as primary evidence** (those are real abandonment moments), and treat the social comment language as secondary color.

Frame discipline by persona

- **Natalie** — body shame is off-limits. The frame is *return* to a prior self, not transformation.
- **Brandon** — replacement framing kills the sale ("you bought wrong"). Completion framing earns it ("you were missing the active compound").
- **Paula** — the structural objection is "if it's hormonal, gut products can't fix it." Mechanism reframe is

- mandatory before any product mention.
- **Paul** — practitioner-to-practitioner only. Never lifestyle imagery, never customer-voice testimonials. Trade-publication aesthetic.
 - **Isaac** — male peer voice, not influencer. Podcast-clip register. No smiling stock people.

Phase 1 scope discipline (from week 1)

- This is paid acquisition + dedicated bold LPs **only**. Main site stays measured under the polite voice.
- This is a **conversion test of the voice**, not a brand-level reset.
- Phase 2 (post-validation): manifesto page, founder origin video, homepage hero migration.
- Phase 3 (optional): packaging, PR, whole-brand voice unification.

11. Recommended Phase 1 ship sequence

1. **Week 1** — Ship `pain-010` as the headline test. Single static, three creative variants (font weight + background, positioning, etc). Get the headline in front of the line.
2. **Week 1** — Ship `pain-002` and `hook-001` as the receipt-arsenal partners. Both lean on the 70% number: one as typography, one as visual.
3. **Week 2** — If `pain-010` shows lift, layer in `pain-012` (the bloating reframe) and `love-010` (the long-form vindication card).
4. **Week 2** — Ship `hook-002` as the cornerstone video. Highest production cost in the top 10, gates on the static results.
5. **Week 3** — Add `pain-006` (receipts ingredient card) for evaluation-stage retargeting and `pain-008` (faux-zempic) for product-aware retargeting.
6. **Week 3** — Build the Paul practitioner long-form (separate brief shape, not in the matrix top 10 — derived from rows tagged `solution_aware` + `authority_bias`).
7. **Week 4** — Re-imagine `hook-002` (category and reframe) and `pain-002` (action response no) as the second wave of `pain_vs_competitor` variants.

Total: 9 ads + 1 long-form across 4 weeks. Diversity across all 4 mental stages (trigger / exploration / evaluation / purchase) by week 3.

File references

What	Where
Bold voice rules	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/brand.yaml</code>
Strategic spine	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/positioning.md</code>
Brand context	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/brand-context.md</code>
Personas (6)	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/avatars/*.yaml</code>
Gap map	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/research/competitive-gaps.{yaml,md}</code>
VOC corpus	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/voc/extracted_pains.yaml</code>
Creative matrix	<code>clients/secondkind-bold/strategy/creative_matrix.{yaml,xlsx}</code>

